

“Undoubtedly the **most heroic action** in US Air Force history—**bar none.**”

US AIR FORCE VETERAN SAM MCGOWAN, ON THE EVACUATION OF KHAM DUC, OCTOBER 2015

Phase two

Communist forces attacked Saigon again on May 25. Rather than trying to capture or disrupt Tan Son Nhut airbase or other US facilities, the Viet Cong concentrated their efforts on Cholon, the city's main ethnic Chinese district. Assuming that religious shrines would be safe from attack, the Viet Cong took refuge inside Buddhist temples. The assumption proved wrong, however, and ARVN and US troops gradually drove them from the city.

The May offensive had proved ineffective. Better intelligence gathering in the wake of the first Tet Offensive enabled US and ARVN forces to intercept many NVA units before they could reach their targets.